

Charles Taragin

PRINCIPAL ECONOMIST

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CITIZENSHIP

United States

EXPERIENCE

Federal Reserve Board

PRINCIPAL ECONOMIST

Washington DC

September 2022 - present

- Work closely with attorneys and economists to analyze the effect of bank mergers and divestitures.

Federal Trade Commission

ECONOMIST

Washington DC

June 2019 - September 2022

- Work closely with attorneys and economists to model and quantify the effect of mergers and other potentially anti-competitive behavior.

Antitrust Division, U.S. Department of Justice

ECONOMIST

Washington DC

September 2007 - May 2019

- Work closely with attorneys to model and quantify the effect of mergers and other potentially anti-competitive behavior.
- Analyze the effects of various tariffs proposed by the Trump administration.
- Antitrust casework focuses on collusion and monopolization in financial markets, as well as merger analysis in the health insurance, advertising, airlines, and electricity industries.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of horizontal mergers. Versions of this code has been used in numerous antitrust investigations as well as in litigation.
- Authored code and documentation implementing numerous models to calibrate and simulate the effect of tariffs and quotas.
- Designed and coded web interfaces for merger and tariff simulation.
- Designed and maintained large databases (over 10 TB) for use in investigations and litigation.

EDUCATION

Economics

PHD

University of Michigan

2007

Economics

MASTERS

University of Michigan

2004

Public Policy

MASTERS

University of Chicago

2000

Economics

BACHELORS

University of Chicago

1999

PUBLICATIONS

1. Taragin, C., & Taylhardat, M. (2025). A distance-based algorithm for defining antitrust markets. *Finance Research Letters*, 86, 108972. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.frl.2025.108972>
2. Benson, D., Bord, V., Garner, A., & Taragin, C. (2023). *Size and survival of entrants to retail banking*. Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System; FEDS Notes. <https://doi.org/10.17016/2380-7172.3345>
3. Panhans, M. T., & Taragin, C. (2023). Consequences of model choice in predicting horizontal merger effects. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 89, 102986. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijindorg.2023.102986>
4. Vita, M., Brand, K., Larson-Koester, M., Petek, N., Taragin, C., Violette, W., & Wood, D. H. (2022). Economics at the FTC: Estimating harm from deception and analyzing mergers. *Review of Industrial Organization*, 61(4), 405–438. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11151-022-09883-w>
5. Sheu, G., & Taragin, C. (2021). Simulating mergers in a vertical supply chain with bargaining. *The RAND Journal of Economics*, 52(3), 596–632. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1756-2171.12385>
6. Froeb, L. M., Mares, V., Tschantz, S., & Taragin, C. (2018). The simple algebra of surplus in private values open auctions: A nested logit merger model. *Economics Bulletin*, 38(4), 2304–2312. <https://ideas.repec.org/a/eb1/ecbull/eb-18-00431.html>
7. Froeb, L. M., Pittman, R. W., Taragin, C. S., Tschantz, S., & Werden, G. J. (2018). Economics at the Antitrust Division: 2017–2018. *Review of Industrial Organization*, 53(4), 637–651. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11151-018-9662-8>

8. Borzekowski, R., Thomadsen, R., & Taragin, C. (2009). Competition and price discrimination in the market for mailing lists. *QME*, 7(2), 147–179. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11129-009-9050-7>

UNDER REVIEW

1. Taragin, C., Wallace, B., & Watkins, E. (2025). *Financial structure and mergers* (No. 2025-080; Finance and Economics Discussion Series). Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System. <https://doi.org/10.17016/FEDS.2025.080>
2. Hosken, D., Larson-Koester, M., & Taragin, C. (2025). *Labor and product market effects of mergers*.

IN PROGRESS

1. Benson, D., Loudermilk, M., & Taragin, C. (2026). *Merger screening under uncertain conduct*.
2. Benson, D., Garner, A., Sheu, G., & Taragin, C. S. (2026). *Merger effects and efficiencies under uncertainty: Evidence from supreme court decisions on banking*.
3. Loudermilk, M., Sheu, G., & Taragin, C. (2023). *Beyond “Horizontal” and “Vertical”: The welfare effects of complex integration* (No. 2023-005; Finance and Economics Discussion Series). Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System. <https://doi.org/10.17016/FEDS.2023.005>

PRESENTATIONS

FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION	11/2025
DC IO DAY	5/2019
INTERNATIONAL INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION CONFERENCE	4/2019
FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION	6/2018, 7/2018
INTERNATIONAL COMPETITION NETWORK	2018
INTERNATIONAL INDUSTRIAL ORGANIZATION CONFERENCE	2018
FEDERAL COMMUNICATION COMMISSION	8/2018, 2013
U.S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE	2012, 2017

R SOFTWARE PACKAGES

ANTITRUST

- A collection of tools for antitrust practitioners, including merger simulation models, market definition, and equilibrium pricing. Calibrates demand parameters and simulates mergers under various differentiated products demand systems including logit, nested logit, ces, and aids.

TRADE

- A collection of tools for trade policy analysis. Provides trade policy practitioners with a tractable framework for simulating the effects of tariffs, quotas, and other trade policy measures on market outcomes.

COMPETITIONTOOLBOX

- A graphical user interface for the antitrust and trade R packages. Provides an interactive interface for conducting merger simulations, market definition analysis, and trade policy analysis without requiring R programming knowledge.

SERVICE

US DOJ/KFTC KNOWLEDGE EXCHANGE PROGRAM 2018

- Organized, co-authored and co-taught a 3 day training program for new economists at the Korean Free Trade Commission (KFTC). The purpose of this program was to train KFTC economists in how to analyze horizontal mergers.

ALGORITHMIC DOCUMENT REVIEW 2017

- Trained a series of machine learning classifiers to predict if a document is pertinent to an investigation. Once these models have been fully tested, they will greatly reduce the time needed to review the massive amount of documents received by the Antitrust Division.

R TRAINING 2012 - present

- Authored and co-taught a series of short courses for Economists and Research Analysts on R. Covered topics included: data analysis, plotting, regression analysis, mapping, interfacing with databases, and antitrust analysis.

AWARDS

TEAM SPECIAL ACHIEVEMENT AWARD FOR WORK ON CAPITAL ONE/DISCOVER MERGER 2025

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR POSITIVE EXTERNALITY 2019

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON ANTHEM/CIGNA LITIGATION 2017

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR EXTRAORDINARY ACHIEVEMENT 2016

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON NATIONAL CINEMEDIA/SCREENVISION LITIGATION 2015

TEAM AWARD FOR WORK ON AMERICAN/US AIRWAYS LITIGATION 2014

EAG MANAGEMENT AWARD FOR PUSHING FRONTIERS 2010

COMPUTER SKILLS

AI & LLM TOOLS

- Claude Code, OpenAI Codex

PROGRAMMING

- Python, C++, Java

STATISTICS

- R, Stata, SAS

DATABASE

- PostGreSQL, PostGIS, MySQL, Microsoft SQL, DuckDB, SQLite

MARKUP

- Markdown, LaTeX